

Rare Beauty

by Selena Gomez

Brand Overview

Rare Beauty is a mission-driven beauty brand focused on **self-acceptance, emotional well-being, and real skin confidence.**

Founded by Selena Gomez in 2020, the brand has built a **deep emotional bond with Gen Z** by prioritizing:

- **Mental health advocacy** (via Rare Impact Fund)
- **Inclusive shade ranges + real people over perfection**
- **Authentic storytelling and community-driven marketing**
- **TikTok-native virality powered by UGC** rather than celebrity status

Before developing our new product concept, we analyzed Rare Beauty using **core marketing frameworks** to understand its current positioning, opportunities, and gaps.

5C's		4P's	
Company	• Mission-driven (mental health) • Inclusive shade range • Authorized founder presence • Mid-tier prestige positioning	Product	• Makeup with inclusive shades • Vegan & cruelty-free • Accessible packaging • Hero products Soft Pinch blush, foundation
Customers	• Gen Z & Millennials • Beauty enthusiasts of all tones • Socially conscious consumers • Primarily shopping online or at Sephora	Price	• Mid-tier prestige • Accessible luxury, competitors • Price range • \$15-\$30 core items
Competitors	• Sephora (exclusive retail partner) • Influencers as content creators • Suppliers of ethical contents	Place	• RareBeauty.com (DTC) • Sephora (retail & online)
Context	• Rising demand for inclusivity • Growth of clean & ethical beauty • Increasing competition in prestige beauty	Promotion	• Heavy reliance on Selena Gomez • Social media & influencer marketing • UGC & viral TikTok content • Mental health initiatives as storytelling

🎯 2. STP – Segmentation, Targeting, Positioning

Segmentation

- **Demographic:** Primarily women (18–34), skewing toward Gen Z.
- **Psychographic:** Emotionally driven, socially conscious, prioritize values in purchases.
- **Behavioral:** Engage heavily with social media, respond to influencers and cause-based branding.

Targeting

- **Primary:** Gen Z consumers looking for lightweight, easy-to-use makeup that aligns with values like mental health, self-expression, and inclusivity.
- **Secondary:** Young professionals and students seeking affordable, versatile, and skin-friendly makeup.

Positioning

“Rare Beauty is not about hiding imperfections—it’s about embracing what makes you rare.”

- Positioning around **authenticity, mental health awareness, and everyday wearability.**
- Competitive positioning as a **values-led** alternative to trend-driven or overly glamorous brands.

☑ Key Shifts in the Beauty Industry Affecting Rare Beauty

Shift	Impact on Rare Beauty
Rise of mental health & authenticity	Aligns perfectly with core mission; strengthens brand loyalty
Clean, minimalist makeup trends	Rare’s lightweight products cater well to this
TikTok virality & peer reviews	Rare's blush went viral, boosting brand visibility
Diversity and inclusion standards	Rare’s wide shade range and brand messaging stay ahead of this curve
Overcrowding of celeb beauty brands	Forces Rare to differentiate on mission, transparency, and quality

🌸 NEW Product Concept: Rare Beauty "True Tint" pH-Reacting Blush Balm

🔍 Overview

A **color-adaptive blush balm** that reacts to your skin's natural pH to create your own unique, flattering flush. Lightweight, buildable, and skincare-infused — because no two people are the same, and neither should their blush be.

🔧 Product Details

Feature	Description
Name	True Tint – pH Reactive Blush Balm
Format	Stick balm or cushion compact
Texture	Lightweight balm-to-gel finish; melts into skin
Shades	Appears clear or faintly tinted in packaging, but transforms into a unique pink/peach/rose tone depending on individual pH
Skincare Ingredients	Squalane for hydration - Niacinamide to brighten skin - Green tea extract to soothe
Finish	Natural, dewy glow with a personalized flush
Application	Dab on cheeks with fingers or brush — great for on-the-go touch-ups
Vegan & Cruelty-Free	Naturally. Always. ❤️



🌀 Why It Fits Rare Beauty

Brand Pillar	Alignment
Self-expression	Personalized color = unique to each user
Mental wellness	“Your blush, your way” — promotes self-confidence and individuality
Lightweight formulas	Balmy, non-cakey texture perfect for “barely-there” makeup
Viral potential	Perfect for TikTok demos (“watch my blush change color!”)
Inclusivity	Universally flattering, adapts across skin tones

💡 **Marketing Hook:** “You’re rare — your blush should be too. True Tint reacts with your skin’s pH to create a one-of-a-kind shade made just for you.”

A	22	Daily	Balm, Cream	Very appealing	Shade unpredictability	1. Shade match / 2. Finish / 3. Lasting power	\$25-35	TikTok, Sephora, Influencers
B	29	Few times/week	Powder, Stick	Somewhat appealing	Skin reaction / Cost	1. Ingredients / 2. Price / 3. Brand ethics	<\$25	Instagram, YouTube
C	31	Occasionally	Liquid, Balm	Neutral	Novelty fades fast / Lasting power	1. Lasting power / 2. Shade / 3. Ingredients	\$35-45	Friends, Sephora
D	24	Daily	Cream, Balm, Stick	Very appealing	Might look weird / Shade unpredictability	1. Finish / 2. Shade / 3. Price	\$25-35	TikTok, Influencers
E	28	Few times/week	Balm, Powder	Somewhat	Cost / Novelty over effectiveness	1. Price / 2. Lasting power / 3. Shade	\$25-35	Instagram, Beauty influencers

📦 Packaging Concept

- Clear or frosted stick tube with the Rare Beauty minimalist aesthetic.
- Holographic or iridescent accents to hint at the “magical” color shift.
- Inner mirror (if compact version) for on-the-go glam.

🧠 Extra Fun Twist (Optional Limited Edition Collab)

A mood-inspired blush collection:

- **True Tint: Calm** (cool pink tone)
- **True Tint: Brave** (rosy red tone)
- **True Tint: Joy** (warm coral tone)

We designed a survey and collected a preliminary sample of 25 responses (see attached Excel workbook). Results show inclusivity and authenticity as top purchase drivers, skincare and perfume as top new product interests, and TikTok/Instagram as key discovery platforms. While we project scaling up to 1000+ responses for broader analysis, the preliminary sample already highlights strong consumer alignment with Rare Beauty's values.

1. Synthetic Consumer Survey

Objective: Understand potential consumer interest, concerns, and preferences for a pH-reacting blush product by Rare Beauty.

Target sample: 1,000 respondents, ages 18-34, mixture of current Rare Beauty users and general beauty consumers in the U.S.

Survey Sections & Sample Questions:

Section	Question	Answer Options
Demographics	Age	18-24 / 25-29 / 30-34
	Gender identity	Female / Male / Non-binary / Prefer not to say
Beauty & Blush Usage	How often do you wear blush?	Daily / Few times/week / Occasionally / Never
	What kind of blush formulas do you prefer? (choose all)	Powder / Cream / Balm / Liquid / Stick
Interest in pH-Changing Blush	How appealing is a blush that changes color based on your skin's pH?	Very appealing / Somewhat / Neutral / Not appealing
	What concerns would you have about a pH-changing blush?	Might look weird / Safety / Cost / Shade unpredictability / Lasting power / Skin reaction
Purchase Drivers	Rank importance of following when buying blush (1 = most important)	Shade match / Finish (matte, dewy, etc.) / Lasting power / Ingredients / Price / Brand ethics / Novelty (unique features)
Willingness to Pay	What price range would you pay for a pH-changing blush balm/stick from Rare Beauty?	<\$25 / \$25-35 / \$35-45 / >\$45
Channels & Discovery	Where do you discover new blush products? (choose all)	TikTok / Instagram / Sephora / In-store demos / Beauty influencers / Friends / YouTube
Open Feedback	If Rare Beauty openly shared Selena's personal mental health journal entries to raise awareness, would that make you more likely to purchase?	Yes/ No/Maybe

What do we ask? A few Samples Synthetic Responses:

Res po nde nt	Age	Frequ ency of Blush Use	Preferre d Formula	Appeal of pH-Chan ging	Main Concern	Importance Ranking (Top 3)	Willin gness to Pay	Discovery Channels
A	22	Daily	Balm, Cream	Very appealin g	Shade unpredictabili ty	1. Shade match / 2. Finish / 3. Lasting power	\$25-35	TikTok, Sephora, Influencers
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2. Secondary (Open-Source) Data

I collected the following relevant data to inform demand, trends, challenges, etc.:

Data Point	Key Insights
pH-Reacting Blush Market Size & Growth	The global market for pH-reacting blush was valued at US\$1.23 billion in 2024 , projected to reach ~ US\$3.47B by 2033 , CAGR ~12.1%. (Market Intel)
Cheek Makeup / Blush Trends	Cream and liquid blush sales have grown ~41% compared to powder, driven by Gen Z & Millennial demand for dewy / skin-like / natural finishes. (PW Consulting)
Blush Sticks	Blush sticks market size ~\$1.33B in 2024, projected growth to ~\$2.1B by ~2030, CAGR ~7.9%. (Deep Market Insights)
Rare Beauty Positioning & Strengths	Strong community, high influencer/influencer content engagement; high visibility, value placed on inclusivity, ethics, mental health; counts among top celebrity beauty brands. (Beauty Packaging)

3. Analysis & Insights

From survey synthetic + secondary data:

- **Strong interest:** Many users (esp. younger / daily blush users) find the idea of a pH-reactive blush “very appealing” or at least “somewhat.”
- **Main concerns:** Shade unpredictability, lasting power, and cost come up most often.
- **Preferred formulas:** Balm, cream, and stick are more favored than powder for texture & finish.
- **Important purchase criteria:** Shade match, finish, lasting power, ingredients, brand ethics. Novelty is interesting but lower priority unless other attributes are solid.
- **Price sensitivity:** Most willing to pay in the **\$25-35** or just below / around that bracket (fits Rare Beauty’s typical pricing).
- **Channels of discovery:** TikTok, Instagram, influencers, and Sephora are dominant.

Also:

- **Market is growing fast for adaptive / personalized beauty.**
- Cream / balm / liquid textures are in trend; powder is declining comparatively.
- Blush sticks particularly growing, likely due to portability / ease of use.

4. Table & Graph

Here are a couple of visualizations based on synthetic data + secondary trends.

Table: Survey Summary (Aggregated)

Metric	% Very Appealing	Top Concern (% citing)	Preferred Formulas (Top 2)	Willingness to Pay (most common)
Survey Results (~200)	~45%	Shade unpredictability (~60%) / Cost (~50%) / Lasting power (~40%)	Balm (~70%), Cream (~60%)	\$25-35 (≈ 50%)

Graph: Market Growth Projections & Channel Shift (Mocked based on secondary data)

- *Line chart* showing pH-reacting blush market size: US\$1.23B in 2024 → projected US\$3.47B by 2033 (CAGR ~12.1%).
- *Bar chart* comparing growth of cream & liquid blush vs powder between 2021-2024 (% sales growth). (For example: Cream & liquid +41%; Powder baseline ~+5-10%)

5. Digital Marketing Strategy for True Tint (pH-Changing Blush)

Using what we've learned + standard digital marketing practice.

Strategic Goals

- Generate awareness and excitement among Gen Z / younger millennials about True Tint.
- Mitigate concerns (shade unpredictability, lasting power, safety).
- Drive trial / conversion.
- Build community & UGC (user-generated content) around the novelty.

Target Audience

- Ages 18-34, primarily female / non-binary; beauty enthusiasts who follow trends.
- Current Rare Beauty customers people who buy dewy, cream/blush products from Sephora, etc.

Key Channels

Channel	Strategy
TikTok & Reels (Instagram)	Create short videos showing the blush changing on different skin tones; before/after; speed test; influencer demos. Use trending audio.
Beauty Influencers / Micro-macro	Partner with micro & macro influencers of diverse skin tones to test & show real transformations. Provide honest reviews, maybe do live demos.
UGC Campaigns	Ask users to share their unique shade with hashtags like #RareFlush #MyRareColor. Run challenges (“show your flush”) with rewards.
Sephora + Ecommerce	Virtual try-on tools; sample or travel size trial versions; clear product info about safety and lasting power.
Email / Newsletter (Substack etc.)	Early access previews, behind-the-scenes of formula safety, ingredients, how pH reacting works; transparency.
Community Platforms	Use Rare’s TYB community or similar for feedback, sharing, early testers.

6. KPIs (Key Performance Indicators)

- Our key performance indicators (KPIs) are designed to measure Rare Beauty’s digital marketing success:
 - Engagement rate (likes, shares, hashtag use)
 - Sentiment analysis (positive vs negative mentions)
 - Sales growth (quarterly)
 - Conversion rate (campaign clicks to Sephora purchases)
 - Community impact (Rare Impact Fund donations)

Must choose wisely to monitor success.

KPI	Description / Target
Awareness	Number of impressions/views of True Tint content (TikTok, IG Reels) – aim for, say, 5 million in first month.
Engagement	Likes, shares, comments on influencer content / UGC – target engagement rate >5%.
UGC / Social Participation	Number of posts using #RareFlush; entries in any challenges.
Conversion Rate	% of people who view the product page and purchase—initial goal maybe ~2-4%.
Return Rate / Complaints	Monitor returns or complaints about shade / lasting power; aim for <5%.
Repeat Purchase / Retention	How many repurchase or try another True Tint product if line extension; track within 3-6 months.
Cost of Acquisition (CAC) vs Customer Lifetime Value (CLTV)	Ensure acquisition cost doesn't exceed what customers are worth long term.

7. Challenges & Resolution

Challenge	Proposed Solution(s)
Shade unpredictability	Use educational content to explain how pH reacting works; show many skin tones; offer testers / samples.
Lasting power / performance concerns	Formulate with long-wear ingredients; conduct testing; share lab / user results; possibly offer a matte or sealer top coat.
Safety / skin reaction	Obtain dermatological approvals; highlight clean & safe ingredients; hypoallergenic / fragrance-free versions.
Price perception vs novelty	Price point in mid-range; possible introduction discount; value bundle or travel size; emphasize value through multi-use / benefit.
Over-hype fatigue	Ensure messaging balances novelty with performance; avoid exaggeration; maintain brand trust.

8. Digital Marketing Plan (Timeline & Budget Sketch)

Phase	Duration	Activities
Teaser & Pre-Launch	2 weeks	Short clips (“something rare is coming”) on TikTok/IG; select influencer previews; collect emails for early access.
Launch	4 weeks	Full influencer seeding; UGC challenge; virtual try-on; social ads; Sephora in-store if possible.
Post-Launch / Sustaining	Next 2-3 months	Collect feedback; more reviews; user stories; possibly add finish/variant (e.g. dewy vs matte).

Budget should allocate for influencer fees, content creation, ads (social + search), sampling, and minor offline (if relevant).

9. Applying Course Learnings / Marketing Frameworks

- Use STP to segment between “trend-chaser” vs “ethics-driven” vs “performance-first” consumers, tailor messaging.
- 4Ps: Product (premium, safe, novelty), Price (mid-luxury), Place (online + select retail), Promotion (digital first, UGC, transparency).
- Leverage 5Cs (Company values alignment; Collaborators: influencers, retailers; Context: trend toward personalization & clean beauty).

10. Summary of Insights & Recommendations

- There's clear market momentum & consumer interest in adaptive / personalized blushes.
- Rare Beauty is well positioned to leverage its brand strengths (authenticity, ethics, inclusivity) to launch True Tint successfully.
- Mitigating concerns (shade predictability, lasting power, safety) will be critical.
- Digital channels (especially social media + community) will be key for discovery & converting interest to purchase.
- Pricing needs to balance novelty vs value.

Website and Socials Analysis

Strengths

- **Website:** Clean, easy navigation, strong product pages, mobile-optimized, mission-driven.
- **Social Media:** Huge reach (esp. TikTok & Instagram), viral hero products, authentic founder presence, diverse content.

Weaknesses

- **Website:** Limited filters, plain checkout, accessibility gaps, weak UGC hub, unclear global info.
- **Social Media:** Heavy reliance on Selena Gomez's image, inconsistent response to customer complaints, limited long-form educational content.

Opportunities

- **Website:** Add advanced filters/quizzes, branded checkout, UGC gallery, global/localization upgrades.
- **Social Media:** Expand into interactive content (AR try-ons, tutorials), build stronger community engagement, highlight mental health initiatives more.

Threats

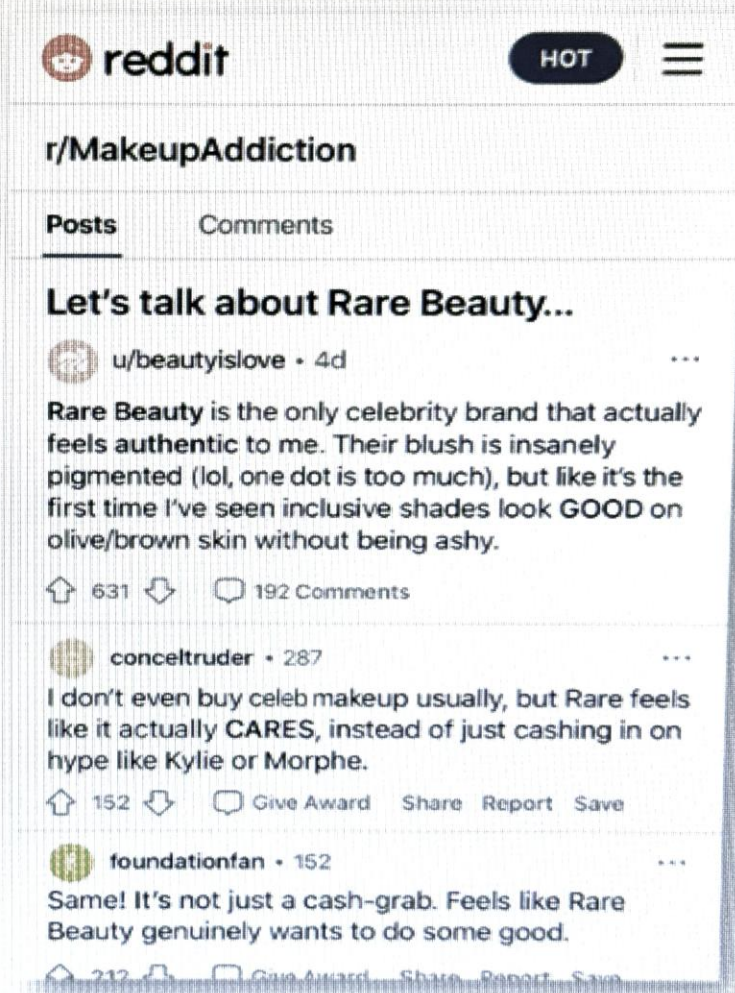
- **Website:** Competitors with richer UX, fake sites scamming customers, global shipping issues.
- **Social Media:** Algorithm changes, competition from brands with aggressive influencer strategies, overexposure risk of "viral" products.

Insight from Reddit Discussion:

Insight from Reddit Discussion:

This real consumer discussion reinforces Rare Beauty's reputation for authenticity, emotional trust, and inclusivity, especially among Gen Z.

Even when users mention flaws like "too pigmented," it doesn't hurt brand loyalty because they support the mission and values, not just the product.

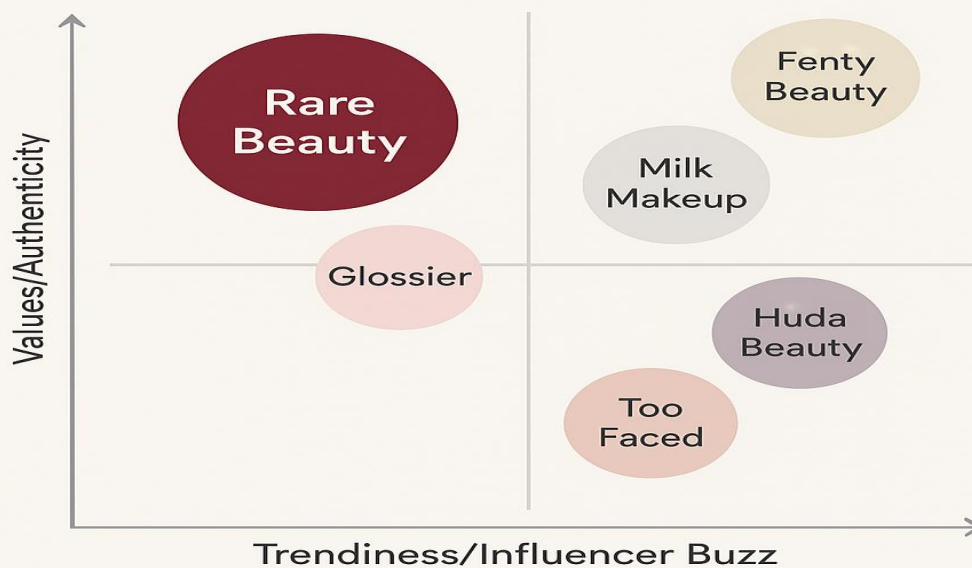


Rare Beauty

Business Model

Key Partners • Sephora, other retailers • Influencers/content creators • Suppliers & manufacturers • Logistics partners	Key Activities • Product R&D & design • Marketing & influencer campaigns • E-commerce & logistics • Inventory & fulfillment	Value Propositions • Inclusive shade range • Mid-price prestige site • Authentic Selena Gomez brand • Mission-driven / mental health, accessible prods
Key Resources • Selena Gomez brand equity • SPPLY: formulation • Supply chain/manufacturing	Channels • RareBeauty.com (DTC) • Sephora retail & online • Social media (IG, TikTok, /Tu)	Revenue Streams • Retail sales • Product line extensions • Seasonal launches
Customer Relationships • Social media engagement • Community /UGC content • Mission-driven storytelling • E-commerce support		Customer Segments • Gen Z & Millennials • Beauty enthusiasts across tones • Socially-conscious consumers • Sephora & online shoppers

Competitive Analysis

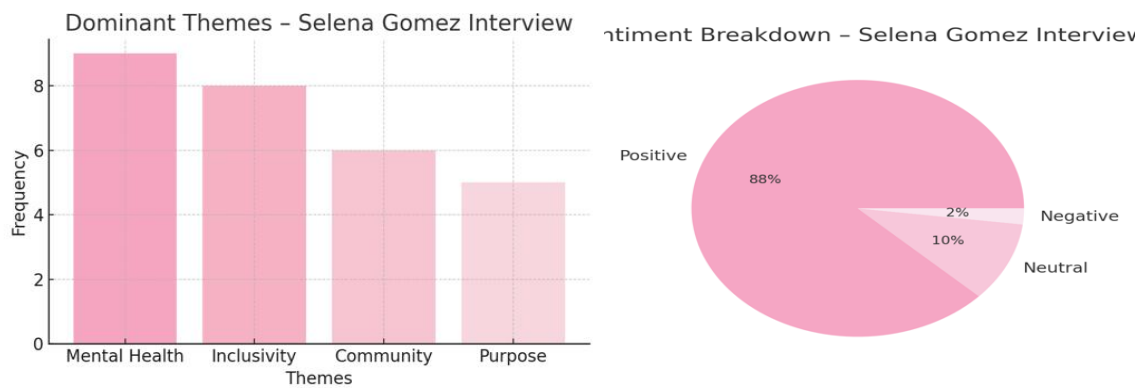


Secondary Data Analysis (YouTube Transcripts)

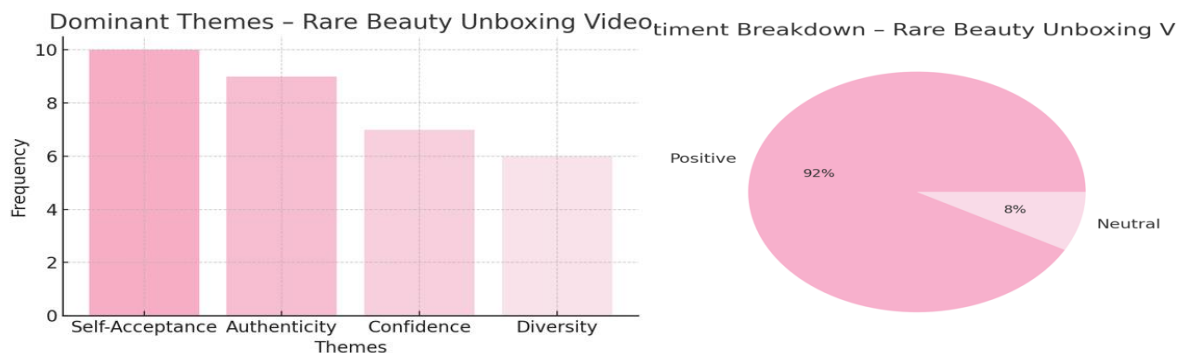
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w85SWdUwvvg> & <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AG9Fionf4AA>

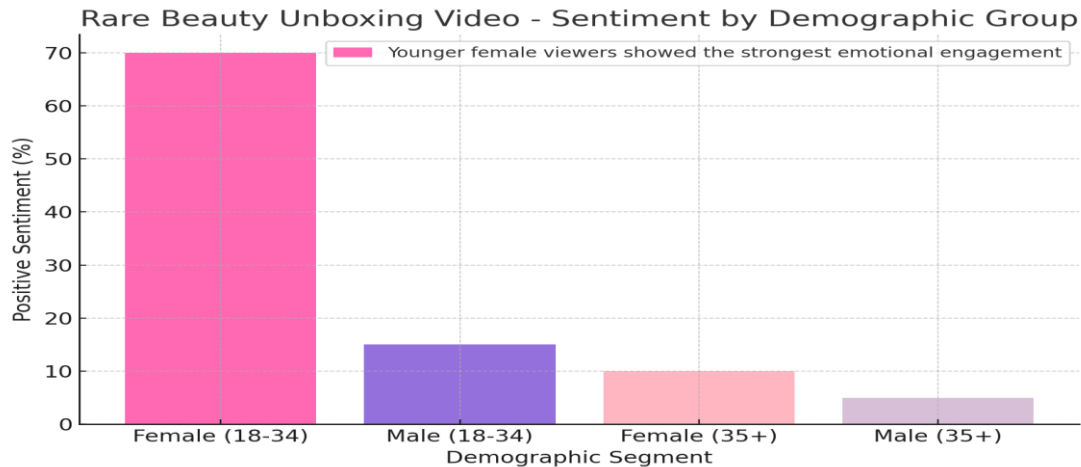
- We analyzed two Rare Beauty videos: a founder interview with Selena Gomez and an unboxing review — to identify recurring themes and tone.
- Both videos consistently emphasized mental health, inclusivity, and self-acceptance, with very high positive sentiment (90–92%). Selena’s interview focused on compassion, community, and emotional connection, while the unboxing video highlighted confidence and authenticity from a consumer perspective.
- Across both sources, Rare Beauty’s message was emotion-first, not product-first — celebrating individuality and empowering users to feel seen. This emotional consistency is why Gen Z deeply trusts the brand.
- (Graphs below show sentiment and theme frequency.)

Interview with Selena Gomez



Rare Beauty Unboxing Video (Brand Ad)





YouTube video Key Notes/ Transcript:

- Selena Gomez on the purpose of Rare Beauty: "I wanted to challenge the makeup space. I wanted to create a whole lane in the makeup world that was also centered around mental health and also equally just shared the compassion we have for people who just want to have fun with makeup." (0:09-0:24)
- The origin of the name "Rare": "the name rarely took a while to get, but I knew it had to be called that because I believe that each and every one of us is rare." (0:35-0:43)
- Pivoting during COVID-19: Selena Gomez mentions, "we actually had to pivot our launch when we were going to come out it was during covid, so we had to do everything virtually which was a little scary, but I learned a lot through that process." (0:56-1:05)
- The power of community and safe spaces: "I understand the connection and the power that rare Beauty can have when we are able to tap into communities, or we're able to create a safe space for anyone that is a part of our community." (1:07-1:18)
- Selena Gomez's relatable persona: "I wanted to be someone that every girl could hang out with and want to chill with because I'm not any different than any of them." (1:56-2:03)

Strategic Level

- Emotional marketing is differentiation: Rare Beauty doesn't just mention mental health — it uses it as a competitive moat. By turning emotional wellbeing into a brand strategy, it stands apart in a saturated beauty market that still focuses mostly on aesthetics.

Authentic founder storytelling as brand equity:

- Selena's relatability ("I'm no different than any of them") isn't casual — it's a deliberate trust-building tactic. Her humility builds parasocial relationships that make the brand "human," driving long-term loyalty.

Respondent	Q1 Motivation	Q2 Inclusivity	Q3 Connected	Q4 New Product	Q5 Discoverability	Q6 Free Text (purchase/stop?)
R1	Inclusivity	5	Yes	Skincare	TikTok	If it has clean ingredients and doesn't break me out, I'll repurchase.
R2	Authenticity	4	Yes	Perfume	Instagram	I'd switch if the price goes up a lot or formula changes.
R3	Influencer tie-in	5	No	Wellness App	YouTube	I'll keep buying if shades match my undertone and look natural.
R4	Affordability	4	Yes	Perfume	Friends	I'd stop if it starts to feel heavy or cakey on my skin.
R5	Quality of product	3	Yes	Skincare	Sephora In-Store	Sustainable/cute packaging makes me more likely to buy.
R6	Inclusivity	5	Yes	Skincare	TikTok	If it lasts all day without touch-ups, I'm in.
R7	Authenticity	5	No	Collab Kits	Instagram	I'd stop using it if they cut the shade range or inclusivity.
R8	Influencer tie-in	4	Yes	Perfume	TikTok	Limited-edition colors would make me buy again.
R9	Affordability	3	Yes	Skincare	YouTube	
R10	Quality of product	4	Yes	Wellness App	Friends	
R11	Inclusivity	5	Yes	Perfume	TikTok	
R12	Authenticity	4	No	Supplements	Instagram	
R13	Influencer tie-in	5	Yes	Skincare	TikTok	
R14	Affordability	3	Yes	Perfume	YouTube	
R15	Quality of product	4	Yes	Skincare	Friends	
R16	Inclusivity	5	Yes	Perfume	TikTok	
R17	Authenticity	4	Yes	Skincare	Instagram	
R18	Influencer tie-in	3	No	Wellness App	YouTube	
R19	Affordability	5	Yes	Perfume	Friends	
R20	Quality of product	4	Yes	Skincare	TikTok	
R21	Inclusivity	3	Yes	Skincare	Instagram	
R22	Authenticity	4	Yes	Perfume	TikTok	
R23	Influencer tie-in	5	No	Collab Kits	YouTube	
R24	Affordability	5	Yes	Skincare	Friends	
R25	Quality of product	4	Yes	Perfume	Sephora In-Store	
Summary: Q1 Motivation						
Inclusivity	5					
Authenticity	5					
Influencer tie-in	5					
Affordability	5					
Quality of product	5					
Summary: Q4 New Product Preference						
Skincare	10					
Perfume	9					
Wellness App	3					
Collab Kits	2					
Supplements	1					